

insisted that Alma, a talented composer, renounce creative activity to act as a wife and mother. His concentration on his work left little time to satisfy her lively sexual demands. The couple had two daughters, Maria and Anna. The death of Maria in 1907 was a crushing blow. In the same year, Mahler himself was diagnosed as suffering from a life-threatening heart condition. Wearied by harassment from the anti-Semitic press in Vienna, he made a lucrative move to the Metropolitan Opera in New York.



COMPOSER'S HUT, STEINBACH

Mahler often came to write at this cottage on Lake Attersee in Steinbach. It was here, on summer holidays between 1893 and 1896, that he composed parts of his Second and Third Symphonies.

Final years

Mahler was not a success in the US, failing to ingratiate himself with a public demanding showmanship. Elbowed out by Arturo Toscanini at the Metropolitan Opera House, he became conductor